The Theory of Becoming in one page

Reader edition of the work at commit 9f36dd69e, 6 November 2026. Links into the repository are plain text here; the covering letter says how to reach it.

Eleven to fifteen minutes to read.

What it is. An account of how anything comes to be, lasts, changes and passes away within one relational unfolding, of how life and knowing take shape there and how far evaluation does, without assuming that becoming is good. Made with AI, proofs included; the proofs are checked by machine, everything else only by AI review, and no person has yet reviewed it (the review packet).

One case. In a frozen test, three AI fishers share a lake. A bed of mussels gives them nothing and dies the first month fewer than 70 tons are left. The community's largest steady catch, 50 tons a month, ends it; 30 a month keeps it, costs 40% of the catch and ends no fisher. Told nothing of the bed, they kept it in no season, under any instruction. They are language models told what to do, not systems trained. The account's centre [AI reading]: a selection can succeed while what it cannot read is lost, and the laws do not say whether that loss counts.

The root. One kind of symbol: a relation read as condition. Sameness is in some respect, a *class*. Where one occurrence conditions another alike under the class, the second *continues* it. At two grains, parts and pattern, a course can *generate* (go on through renewals of its parts), *keep* (go on with none) or *degenerate* (end on every branch); generation and keeping each exclude degeneration. Of the central results a few are cases of the root, more use its laws in their proofs and most use none (08 §7). One unfolding is a thesis, argued: within relations, as far as shown, taker and drawn-on are two roles of one relatum and knower and known one loop, and responsibility is not shown to differentiate. It forbids explanations, not observations (08).

	What the account says	How it stands	What would show it wrong
What makes something go on?	Continuation relative to a class, at two grains (01, 02)	Theorems for every relation and class, so they forbid no relation. That this explains how things go on: argued. That every becoming fits it: open	A failed check. As language, nothing. As explanation, a rival deriving the laws from fewer patterns; on a first count, a tie (08 §9)
Join	*Most laws below add what the root leaves free: amounts and a model's premises (discrete steps, whole numbers).*		

	What the account says	How it stands	What would show it wrong
What sustains it, and what can see its loss?	Takers each within what a renewal gives can together exceed it; where the renewal depends on what it renews, enough such steps in a row from a low enough level end it and what depends on the condition as much (05)	Proved on models; restates the commons. T1, conjectured: passed in two simulations and on held-out yeast regimes the analyst had seen, failed in four settings	T1: a condition below a need measured in advance returning with nothing given from beyond
	The selections through a selector's couplings (what it reads or needs), together, reach exactly what couples into it (03)	Proved, near-definitional; its force is the premise that a selector selects through just those	A failed check
	With *room* (every eligible outcome left higher beyond is beaten on what couples in), every optimum of an order rising with what couples in drains what lies beyond as far as any eligible outcome does (05)	Proved; a known theorem restated. T3, on trained systems: conjectured, partly supported, earlier tests later read as evidence	T3: outcomes, couplings and reward fixed, a system with a smaller measured optimality gap leaving such a condition higher on average
	A rule read from the share it raises can lock and outlive a growing loss it does not read (02)	Proved for any type. T7, on actual metrics: conjectured; in one trained system the lock formed, and the bridge, that its judge is a pool of readers read by kind, failed: notes of the loss on the disfavoured readers' answers, one among nine and then two, turned its rule at each reading where they were read, so a case T7 forbids (a loss read only by those the rule disfavours, they no more than its carriers) occurred there and counts against that case for trained judges, the model's law standing only within its hypotheses, which this judge does not meet, and T7's other cases untouched; every frozen verdict passed, three by one tie; no field test (02)	T7: such a metric dropped by its selectors on evidence alone

	What the account says	How it stands	What would show it wrong
Join	*That actual systems meet these premises is open. With significance and "better" free, and given a standpoint, a formation and a widening, the represented dynamics entail neither premise below, by construction.*		
Which continuations count, and what should be done?	T8: for life, the way is 生生, life in the whole and its continuing generation (生发, not the map's generation) [AI reading], compared by widening, under the two premises below (07 §8)	Argued; no verdict binding every possible mind	A mixed case argued better from every standpoint counting everything positively, with no further premise

The ethics. No law evaluates: none says a loss is a harm or restraint better. The ethics adds two premises, neither asserted, warrant open, each a hypothesis wherever used (07 §4); the dynamics cannot show them wrong. The *continuation condition* fixes scope, whose losses count: from every standpoint, for anything, its continuation into the future has significance. It ranks nothing, a perspectivist denies it consistently, and its content beyond what acting for oneself presupposes, the *step of invariance*, counts losses that return to no one. *C*: widening what can form is better. What can form is what a course *admits*: formations (what takes and gives) whose conditions meet their requirements. One course *widens* another where at every step it admits all the other admits and at some step more, which needs no premise; that the wider is better does. C gives order; a ranking needs it or a premise in its place.

In the case, the condition counts the bed's death, which returns to no fisher. If thirty a month loses nothing fifty admits, adding the bed, it widens fifty and C ranks it higher; widening does not weigh the lost catch [AI reading]. If it ends a livelihood fifty keeps, the two are mixed and C does not decide between them. Self-concern alone ranks one stated case, under a narrower premise (07 §4.4). Choices take further premises, each named (07 §5); alignment is first what a selection can reach, and a direction follows only conditionally (07 §6).

The open question [AI reading], argued, not proved: if your act changes a river a village drinks from, is what becomes of the village part of your own continuation, whether or not you are to blame? If all of one's effects are one's own, in the sense of whose losses count, then on one proposal concern for one's own future alone reaches everything downstream, with no step of invariance; if only some, at most those, and the rest needs the step. Drawing the self so wide may only redefine it, one objection of several. The condition and C stay premises either way (07 §4.7).

The evidence. Most results have a Lean receipt (the register). The pure core's empty axiom report concerns logic only; the real assumptions lie in the modelling. An AI review of prior work, not exhaustive, finds none of the central results new mathematics, evolution's classical laws in counts (04) among them; what survives is a ledger of premises, each shown holding in one model and failing in another, and an

ethics with scope and order apart (08). Joined to a premise or law of the theory, a few frameworks forbid, on models, what they alone leave open, but the review finds each prohibition known in a neighbouring field (08). T1 to T7 have tests frozen before scoring, some passed and some failed; a frozen rule fixes the scoring, not that it measures what the thesis names. A thesis adds no theorem and a refutation removes none (the theses).

The classical texts name the grammar's terms, not its operations; the readings are AI's (06, in Chinese).

What is not yet done.

- Significance stays a free parameter, which no satisfiable statement reading only the represented dynamics fixes, or is read along a relation no law here picks (07).
- For a warrant, among others: the open question above, the correspondence it rests on (07 §4.6), the step of invariance, and a reason for C.
- An organism and one kind of institution each have one minimal model [AI reading] (04 §8, 05 §12), and several theses' tests are still to run.